MOHRE, WPS and Nafis: what to check and when

For mainland entities registered with MOHRE. Current to November 2026.

Every day

- [ ] MOHRE dashboard for each entity: alerts, inspections, complaints
- [ ] No suspended work permits on any entity file
- [ ] Permits and contracts expiring in 30 days: renewal started
- [ ] New starters: permit approved before day one
- [ ] Yesterday's leavers: permit cancellation started
- [ ] WPS: rejected salary files or failed transfers fixed today
- [ ] Nafis: new applicants answered; any Emirati resignation flagged

Payday is the 1st

No grace period.

Last week	Close payroll inputs, approve, send the WPS file. If the 1st is a weekend or holiday, pay earlier.
Day 0	Wages due. At least 85% of total wages must have cleared.
Day 2	MOHRE alerts; new work permits frozen
Day 5	Administrative fine
Day 11	Repeat offenders: downgrade to Category 3
Day 16	25+ workers: labour dispute registered
Day 21	Enforcement: payment order or collective dispute, asset attachment, travel ban

Nafis and Emiratisation

Entities with 50+ employees need Emiratis in 10% of skilled roles by 31 December 2026. Entities with 20–49 employees in MOHRE's 14 listed sectors must keep at least 2 Emiratis.

Checkpoints are 30 June and 31 December. Each unfilled role costs AED 10,000 a month. Hires must be working by the deadline, not just signed. If an Emirati leaves, restore the rate within 2 months.

An Emirati hire counts only with all four in place:

- [ ] MOHRE national work permit
- [ ] Contract in MOHRE's form
- [ ] Salary through WPS, minimum AED 6,000
- [ ] Pension registered within 1 month

Joiners, changes and leavers

Work down the column that matches what is happening to the employee.

Joiner	Change	Leaver
Offer signed, permit approved	Salary or title amended on MOHRE before it takes effect	Permit cancelled (Emiratis: immediately)
Contract registered; title matches the real role	WPS salary file updated to match	Final dues paid within 14 days
Added to the WPS salary file	Unpaid leave notified to MOHRE	Final payment made through WPS
Emirati: AED 6,000+ and pension registered	Emirati changes reported on Nafis	Emirati: replacement started on Nafis

Escalate the same day

If any of these happen, tell the person on the right before you go home.

Payroll won't clear by the 1st	Finance director and HR head
Under 85% of wages paid on time	Finance director
MOHRE complaint or inspection	HR head; legal for complaints
Emiratisation rate below target	HR head and CEO
Emirati paid under AED 6,000	HR head and payroll
Emirati with no real duties, or roles reclassified to cut the target	Legal counsel